

Stealing the Show

A week ahead of the Wills Lifestyle India Fashion Week, garments worth Rs 60 lakh were stolen from Delhi-based couturier Varun Bahl's warehouse. The 31-year-old will find it impossible to replace some of the heavy couture creations, but is determined to carry on. "My show will be better than ever," he declares. Truly a show of strength.



HEMANT CHAWLA

& SHOBHANA

TONGUE TWIST



Two-time National Award-winning southern actor and danseuse Shobhana, 40, is all set to enthrall Bollywood with Kaushik Roy's *Apna Asmaan* opposite Irrfan Khan. A tête-à-tête:

Q. This is your first Hindi film. How did you prepare yourself?

A. A detailed script in English came to me in advance. I play the role of a Keralite settled in Mumbai, so I dubbed in my own voice.

Q. Why are you doing an offbeat film?

A. It's sincere and easy to relate to, not a song and dance mainstream film.

Q. What comes first—dance or films?

A. I am being very choosy because I want to do meaningful films. So, you may see me more on stage than on the screen.

Coming of Age

Even as older stars are making a beeline for heroines half their age, newcomer **Neha Jhulka**, who debuted with *Kaisay Kahen*, is reported to have turned down an offer to star opposite Ajay Devgan in Raj Kumar Santoshi's *Halla Bol*, an allegation the 22-year-old now denies. Jhulka says she met Santoshi while she was studying management at Mumbai's L.S. Raheja College and "academics were a priority". We hope age brings wisdom.



REUTERS



HOLLYWOOD DAWN

While other designers are hankering to create costumes for Rani Mukherji and Aishwarya Rai, ace Delhi designer Suneet Varma, 40, has bagged himself Goldie Hawn. He will be designing Hawn's costumes in her directorial debut *Ashes to Ashes*, a film about a New Yorker who travels to India to scatter her husband's ashes. "With my background in costume history, I appointed an agent in Los Angeles to pitch for a Hollywood film," says Varma.

The result was *Ashes to Ashes*, to be produced by Michel Shane of *I, Robot* fame. Hollywood calling, indeed.



"CRUNCH CRUNCH CRUNCH."

*I love you.

